



Indian science and technology innovations that will make you proud!

Some of these even surprised me...

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India has been on an unprecedented growth trajectory in the world of science and technology. With an ecosystem that is developing to give more chances to young minds and new ideas to flourish, India's growth has been awe-inspiring for many across the globe. The success of experienced individuals in different fields of science and technology, coupled with the above-stated incubation opportunities for their ideas, has ensured that the country has registered an affirma-

tive presence in the science and technology space.

As a country, we have not only adapted to new trends and emerging technologies but have also developed programmes and technologies that are leading the charge of change. For a country that is not even a century old, this is a big deal! India's prolific growth in the science and technology space inspired me to reflect back and look at some of the key Indian achievements that not only filled me with pride but, I am sure, will also do the same for you as

we celebrate India's 77th Independence Day this 15th of August. These achievements not only highlight India's current stronghold but also project a future that is filled with promise. A promise of advancements and learnings that will push us nowhere but up in the rankings. Let's have a look –

UPI – The seed that grew the plant of digitisation

Remember the days when you had to look for exact change after an auto ride or the horror of realising that you did not carry enough cash to purchase your much-awaited GPU? Well, thanks to the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) introduced in 2016, they are a thing of the past. Now, with just a scan of a QR code, you can make secure payments and reduce your reliance on physical currency.

While UPI has made our lives easier, it has also put India on the global map when it comes to the digital payments ecosystem. Let's put that into context with some numbers. As stated by Reserve Bank of India Governor, Mr Shaktikanta Das, in a press conference



earlier this year, India accounts for 46 per cent of digital payments across the world. Astonishingly, UPI makes up 80 per cent of all the digital payments in the country. If that is not a testament to the widespread adoption of UPI, then I don't know what it would be.

The best part of it all, UPI is now going global! Having already expanded UPI's presence in countries including – Sri Lanka, Mauritius, France, UAE, Singapore, Bhutan, and Nepal, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), along with NPCI International Payments (NIPL) are in the process of expanding the presence of UPI in other countries too! The target for this expansion is to increase UPI's reach to over 20 countries by FY 2028-29.